

GREEN ENERGY

BIOFUELS

Biofuels are fuels derived from plants, algae, or animal waste. Unlike fossil fuels, such as coal or crude oil, which formed from the remains of plants and animals that died millions of years ago, biofuels are renewable, which means they will never run out.

Algae are a promising source of biofuel. When supplied with sunlight and nutrients, they produce a rich oil that can easily be turned into fuel.



FUEL FROM CORN

Corn can also be turned into biofuel. Billions of liters of corn-based fuel, called bioethanol, are produced in the US each year. Although a renewable fuel, farming biofuel crops on a large scale can have an impact on the environment and food supply.

Algae can grow rapidly—some can double their mass in just under 6 hours.

PRODUCING BIOFUELS

Algae take in carbon dioxide from the air when they grow and produce an oil rich in carbon. The oil is extracted and then processed in a refinery to make fuel that can be used to power vehicles. When it burns, it produces the same amount of carbon dioxide it took from the air when it grew.

